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Content

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XSHM Mark 2

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If you're familiar with [XSHM](#)) this is going to look awfully similar (but better). When a script creates a new popup (or tab) it retains control over where to send it at a later date. I talked about [this concept before](#). But let's see what else can be done. What if the attacker uses the `history.length` function to calculate how many pages a user has visited after they left the tab for wherever they landed. The attacker could do something like this:

```
a.location = 'data:text/html;utf-8,<script>alert(history.length);history.go(-1);</script>';
```

By setting either a recursive `setTimeout` or using some manual polling mechanism, the attacker can (in this case) cause a popup which monitors how many pages they've gone. Normally it wouldn't cause a popup, the attacker would redirect to another domain that they had access to which would do the same `history.length` check. Voila. The user only sees a brief white flash and then the same page they were just on - as if nothing happened. They'd probably just think their browser is messing up again. This could be helpful in a number of esoteric situations where the number of pages visited may change, or you may want to force them through several flows (and back and forth again) all with a single mouse click - giving you authority to popup in the first place. The best part is that this will follow them while they surf for as long as both windows stay open.

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